

Suntrail: Your City Discovery Companion

A simple web app that helps travelers find the best-rated hotels, restaurants, cafes, cinemas, and things to do in a city -- all in one place, with real booking links and reviews.

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1. Project Name

Suntrail -- Find Your Next Favorite Place. The name comes from the idea of following a trail through a new city, guided by warm, sunny recommendations instead of guessing.

2. Problem Statement

When someone travels to a new city, they usually don't know where to start. To plan even one day, they end up opening a hotel app, a restaurant app, a reviews site, and a maps app -- and still aren't sure which places are actually good. It takes a lot of time and a lot of tabs just to decide where to eat dinner or what to do at night.

I wanted to fix that by building one simple page where a traveler can pick a city and immediately see the best-rated hotels, restaurants, cafes, cinemas, and entertainment spots, with real reviews and a direct link to book or reserve -- no jumping between five different apps.

3. Target Users

- **Tourists** visiting a city for the first time and not sure where to start.
- **Students or interns** traveling for a short course or program, like this one.
- **Weekend travelers** who want quick, trustworthy suggestions without a lot of research.
- **Anyone planning a trip** who is tired of comparing five different apps just to book dinner.

4. Objectives

- Give users one simple place to explore a city, instead of many separate apps.
- Only show well-rated spots, so users don't have to scroll through everything.
- Make booking effortless by linking straight out to the real booking/reservation site.
- Let users build their own list of favorite places as they browse, like a mini trip planner.
- Keep the whole experience light, warm, and easy on the eyes with a friendly sunset theme.

5. Main Features

Feature	What it does
City picker	Choose from 6 popular cities: Paris, Rome, Dubai, New York, Tokyo, and Bali.
Category browsing	Switch between Hotels, Restaurants, Cafes, Cinemas, and Entertainment.
Search & sort	Search by name, or sort by rating, price, or number of reviews.
Place details	Photo, star rating, price level, address, tags, and traveler reviews.
Booking links	One click opens the real booking or reservation page for that place.
Map & directions	One click opens the location in Google Maps.
My Trip list	Save favorite places with a heart icon; view and manage them anytime.
Surprise Me	Can't decide? This picks a random top-rated place for you.
Top Rated badge	Highlights the single best place in each category.
Responsive design	Works cleanly on both a laptop screen and a phone.

6. Success Criteria

This project is considered successful if:

- A user can go from opening the site to seeing places for a chosen city in just a couple of clicks.
- Every place shown has a working booking link and at least two sample reviews.
- Saved favorites (the My Trip list) stay saved even after closing and reopening the browser.

- The layout looks and works well on both a desktop screen and a mobile phone.
- There are no broken buttons, dead links, or errors during normal browsing.

Note on data: *this version uses a curated demo dataset (169 sample places across 6 cities) instead of a live external API, so the full experience could be built and tested end-to-end within the project timeline. See the README for how real, live data could be connected later.*